



Disappearing photos for Whatsapp

Whatsapp will now allow users to send disappearing photos and videos to their chats. <https://dgit.in/sep21-35>



Oppo under display camera

Oppo has unveiled its next-generation under-screen camera (USC) technology to the world. <https://dgit.in/sep21-36>



TEXTURING ARTISTS

Not all heroes wear capes. Some design them.

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exturing artists create the final skins on top of 3D models for computer generated imagery.

They bring polygons to life by simulating the look and feel of real world materials and textures, using the concept of physics, and a deep understand of how light interacts with everything from cloth to metal to bricks,

THEY GIVE LIFE TO SHAPES

Every scene for a texturing artist is a new world to explore as their job is to make it photoreal. To understand how vital textures are in video games, have a look at this side-by-side

comparison of screenshots from GTA V, with and without textures. Observe the considerable difference made just by the textures.

The gaming industry is not the only place that the job of a texturing artist is limited to. As a texturing artist, you can work on some of the biggest blockbusters such as superhero movies or fantasy TV shows.

Texturing artists are usually known for their fantastic use of colours and the way they play with the lighting of a scene to bring it so close to reality. So, knowledge of colour theory and drawing skills, in addition to good communication and creative skills, is a thing that is a must-have for any individual trying

to enter this industry. Communication skills are needed because if you cannot convey the great ideas that you have floating around in your brain to a team that you are working with or to the executives you are pitching to, the idea may never potentially see the light of the day.

WHAT DO THEY WORK WITH?

There are a host of tools that texturing artists have mastery over. But they are limited to working with like a handful of the ones that are out there. Some of the popular softwares that are used by texturing artists these days are: Maya, 3DS Max and Motionbuilder by Autodesk, Adobe Photoshop, Mudbox, Zbrush, Crazy Bump, Body Paint and Deep Paint. Each of these software has a particular use case for a texturing artist. Most of the work is done on an image editing software such as Adobe Photoshop, being a tool that can be used to design textures from the ground up or blend, mix and layer from stocks.

Autodesk tools are essential as well, with Maya and Motionbuilder being the standard for professional production. A lot of the time the question of which software to use depends on the particular project. For example, a person may be working with Painter all the time but may have to use Photoshop because some part of the work needs to be done using a feature exclusively present on Photoshop.

HOW TO BECOME A TEXTURING ARTIST?

Like it is with any art, the job of a Texture Artist does not need a degree if you have enough mastery over the art and a solid portfolio to back it



A scene from GTA V without textures (left), and with textures (right)

Credits: Image on the left – Kim Laughton via Tumblr; Image on the right – Rockstar Games